MIL-B-81935A
1 June 1987
SUPERSEDING
MIL-B-81935
7 September 1973

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

BEARINGS, PLAIN, ROD END, SELF-ALIGNING, SELF-LUBRICATING, GENERAL SPECIFICATION FOR

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers plain rod end bearings which are self-aligning and self-lubricating by incorporating polytetrafluorethylene (PTFE) in a liner between the ball and outer ring for use in the temperature range -65°F to +325°F.

1.2 Classification. Bearings shall be of the following classes, as specified (see 6.2):

Class 1 - Externally threaded shank

Class 2 - Internally threaded shank

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Government documents.

2.1.1 Specifications, standards and handbooks. The following specifications, standards and handbooks form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of these documents shall be those listed in the issue of the Department of Defense Index of Specifications and Standards (DoDISS), and supplement thereto, cited in the solicitation.

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to: Commanding Officer, Naval Air Engineering Center, SESD (Code 53), Lakehurst, NJ 08733-5100, by using the self-addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

AMSC N/A FSC 3120
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SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

QQ-P-416	Plating, Cadmium (Electrodeposited).

MILITARY

MIL-P-116	Preservation, Methods of.
MIL-B-197	Bearings, Anti-Friction, Associated Parts and Sub-Assemblies, Packaging of.
MIL-S-8879	Screw Threads, Controlled Radius Root With Increased Minor Diameter, General Specification for.
MIL-B-81820	Bearing, Plain, Self-Aligning, Self-Lubricating, Low Speed Oscillation.
MIL-B-81935/1	Bearing, Plain, Rod End, Self-Aligning, Self-Lubricating, Externally Threaded, -65°F to +325°F.
MIL-B-81935/2	Bearing, Plain, Rod End, Self-Aligning, Self-Lubricating, Wide, Internally Threaded, -65°F to +325°F.
MIL-B-81935/3	Locking Device, Rod End.
MIL-B-81935/4	Bearing, Plain, Rod End, Self-Aligning, Self-Lubricating, Narrow, Externally Threaded, -65°F to +325°F.
MIL-B-81935/5	Bearing, Plain, Rod End, Self-Aligning, Self-Lubricating, Narrow, Internally Threaded, -65°F to +325°F.

STANDARDS

MILITARY

DOD-STD-100	Engineering Drawing Practices.
MIL-STD-105	Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129	Marking for Shipment and Storage.
MIL-STD-130	Identification Marking of U. S. Military Property.

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STANDARDS (Continued)

MILITARY (Continued)

MIL-STD-1949	Inspection, Magnetic Particle.
MS14101	Bearing, Plain, Self-Lubricating, Self-Aligning, Low Speed, Narrow, Grooved Outer Ring, -65°F to +325°F.
MS14103	Bearing, Plain, Self-Lubricating, Self-Aligning, Low Speed, Wide, Grooved Outer Ring, -65°F to +325°F.

(Copies of specifications, standards, handbooks, drawings, publications and other Government documents required by contractors in connection with specific acquisition functions should be obtained from the contracting activity or as directed by the contracting activity.)

2.2 Other publications. The following document(s) forms a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of the documents which are DoD adopted shall be those listed in the issue of the DoDISS specified in the solicitation. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of documents not listed in the DoDISS shall be the issue of the nongovernment documents which is current on the date of the solicitation.

American National Standards Institute

ANSI B46.1	Surface Texture, Surface Roughness, Waviness and Lay.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American National Standards Institute, 1430 Broadway, New York, NY 10018.)

Uniform Classification Committee

Uniform Freight Classification Rules

(Application for copies of the above publication should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, 202 Chicago Union Station, Chicago, IL 60606.)

(Nongovernment standards and other publications are normally available from the organizations which prepare or which distribute the documents. These documents also may be available in or through libraries or other informational services.)

2.3 Order of precedence. In the event of a conflict between the text of this specification and the references cited herein (except for associated detail specifications, specification sheets or MS standards), the text of this specification shall take precedence. Nothing in this specification, however, shall supersede applicable laws and regulations unless a specific exemption has been obtained.

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3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Specification sheets. The individual item requirements shall be as specified herein and in accordance with the applicable specification sheet. In the event of any conflict between the requirements of this specification and the specification sheet, the latter shall govern.

3.2 Qualification. Bearings furnished under this specification shall be products which are authorized by the qualifying activity for listing on the applicable Qualified Products List at the time set for opening of bids (see 4.4, 6.3 and 6.3.1).

3.2.1 Product design change. Any change in product design, description, materials or processing procedures will require requalification of the product to an extent determined by the qualifying activity. For the purposes of this specification "change in processing procedures" means a change in any of the following: (1) the company performing rod end body machining, (2) the company performing rod end body heat treating, or (3) the company performing thread forming.

3.3 Bearing cartridge. The bearing cartridge used in these rod ends shall be in accordance with MS14101 or MS14103, shall be qualified to MIL-B-81820 and shall have been subjected to and passed the Quality Conformance Tests of Section 4.4 of MIL-B-81820. If the bearing cartridge used in these rod ends was produced by another manufacturer, the Department of Defense regulations and policies regarding rebranding of products shall apply. These regulations state that when a company wishes to supply a qualified product carrying its own brand designations, but which is manufactured by another firm, the manufacturer shall be requested by the company to certify that the company is authorized to rebrand and distribute the product with its own brand designation. Additional information about these regulations may be obtained from the Naval Air Engineering Center, Systems Engineering and Standardization Department, Code 5311, Lakehurst, NJ 08733-5100.

3.4 Materials. The rod end body materials shall be in accordance with the applicable military specification sheet.

3.4.1 Cadmium plating. The alloy steel rod end bodies shall be cadmium plated in accordance with QQ-P-416, Type II, Class 2. The plated bodies shall be heated to a temperature of 375° ± 25°F within 4 hours after plating but before the chromate treatment and magnetic particle inspection, and held at this temperature for a minimum of 3 hours, after which the bodies shall be allowed to cool normally at room temperature.

3.4.2 Lubrication. Initial grease or oil lubrication of the bearing cartridge will not be permitted. Use of anti-fretting material between the bearing cartridge and the rod end body is permitted.

3.5 Design and construction. The design of the bearing shall conform to the requirements of MIL-B-81935/1, MIL-B-81935/2, MIL-B-81935/4 or MIL-B-81935/5. Construction shall be such that all relative motion will be between the liner and ball. Except as otherwise specified, the details of the working parts shall be optional.

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3.5.1 Dimensions and tolerances. Dimensions and tolerances shall be as specified on the applicable military specification sheet. Dimensions not shown shall be at the option of the manufacturer.

3.5.2 Surface texture. Surface textures shall be in accordance with the applicable military specification sheet and ANSI B46.1. Bearings shall be free of any defects which may be detrimental to satisfactory installation, performance or bearing life, as defined by this specification.

3.5.3 Hardness. Each rod end body shall be tested for hardness as specified in 4.7.5. Alloy steel rod ends shall be tested after heat treatment but before plating. Only rod end bodies with Rockwell readings in the range allowed by the applicable military specification sheet shall be acceptable.

3.5.4 Threads.

3.5.4.1 Class 1 rod ends. Dimensions, form and contour shall conform to MIL-S-8879. Threads shall be rolled after heat treatment. Rerolling of threads to correct dimensional deficiencies shall not be permitted.

3.5.4.2 Class 2 rod ends. Threads shall conform to MIL-S-8879.

3.5.5 Magnetic particle inspection. All rod end bodies shall be examined by magnetic particle inspection as specified in 4.7.6.1. Any rod end bodies having discontinuities equal to or exceeding the limitations specified herein shall be rejected. Care must be exercised to avoid confusing cracks, as described herein, with other discontinuities.

3.5.5.1 Cracks. Rod end bodies shall be free of cracks in any direction or location. A crack is defined as a clean crystalline break passing through the grain or grain boundary without the inclusion of foreign elements.

3.5.5.2 Laps and seams. Rod end bodies may possess laps and seams, except in locations specified in 3.5.5.4 and 3.5.5.5. Except as noted, the depths shall not exceed the amounts specified in Table I. A lap is a surface defect appearing as a seam caused by folding over hot metal fins or sharp corners and then rolling or forging them into the surface, but not welding them. A seam is an unwelded fold or lap which appears as an opening in the raw material as received from the source.

TABLE I. Discontinuity depths. 1/

Bearing Size	-4 and -5	-6	-7	-8 thru -16
Seam Depth (inch) (maximum)	0.005	0.006	0.007	0.008

1/ Depth of discontinuity shall be measured normal to the surface at the point of greatest penetration.

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3.5.5.3 Inclusions. Rod end bodies shall show no evidence of surface or subsurface inclusions at the thread root, hoop-to-shank fillet or in the 3 to 6 to 9 o'clock positions of the hoop (see Figure 1) when inspected in accordance with 4.7.6. Small inclusions in other parts of the rod end body not indicative of unsatisfactory material quality, shall not be cause for rejection.

3.5.5.4 Hoop and hoop-to-shank fillet discontinuities (seams and folds). The rod end body shall not have seams or folds in the 3 to 6 to 9 o'clock positions of the hoop or in the hoop-to-shank fillet. Seams or folds in the 9 to 12 to 3 o'clock positions of the hoop not exceeding the limits of Table I shall not be cause for rejection.

3.5.5.5 Thread discontinuities (laps, seams and surface irregularities). Threads shall have no multiple or single laps at the root or on the sides (Figure 2), except that laps are permissible at the crest which do not exceed 25 percent of basic thread depth, and on the sides outside the pitch diameter (see Figure 3). Deviation from the thread contour is permissible at the crest of the thread as shown in Figure 3. The incomplete thread at each end of the thread may also deviate from contour.

3.6 Performance.

3.6.1 Ultimate static load. No fracture of the rod end body shall occur when the ultimate static load specified on the applicable rod end military specification sheet is applied in accordance with 4.7.1.

3.6.2 Axial static proof load. No pushout of the bearing cartridge from the rod end body shall occur when the axial proof load on the applicable military specification sheet is applied as specified in 4.7.2.

3.6.3 Fatigue load. The rod end bearings shall be capable of withstanding a minimum of 50,000 cycles of loading when tested in accordance with 4.7.3.

3.6.4 Self-alignment. The bearing shall be self-aligning and permit the angular displacement specified on the applicable military specification sheet.

3.6.5 No-load rotational breakaway torque. When tested in accordance with 4.7.4, the no-load breakaway torque shall be within the limits of the values specified on the applicable rod end military specification sheet.

3.7 Interchangeability. All parts having the same manufacturer's part number shall be directly and completely interchangeable with each other with respect to installation and performance. The drawing number requirements of DOD-STD-100 shall govern changes in the manufacturers' part numbers.

3.8 Identification of product. Each bearing shall be permanently and legibly marked with the military identifying part number, the manufacturer's name or trademark, and manufacturer's part number. Where practicable, identification shall appear on the side face of the rod end body; otherwise identification shall appear on the periphery of the rod end body. Metal impression stamping is prohibited. (Marking in accordance with MIL-STD-130.)

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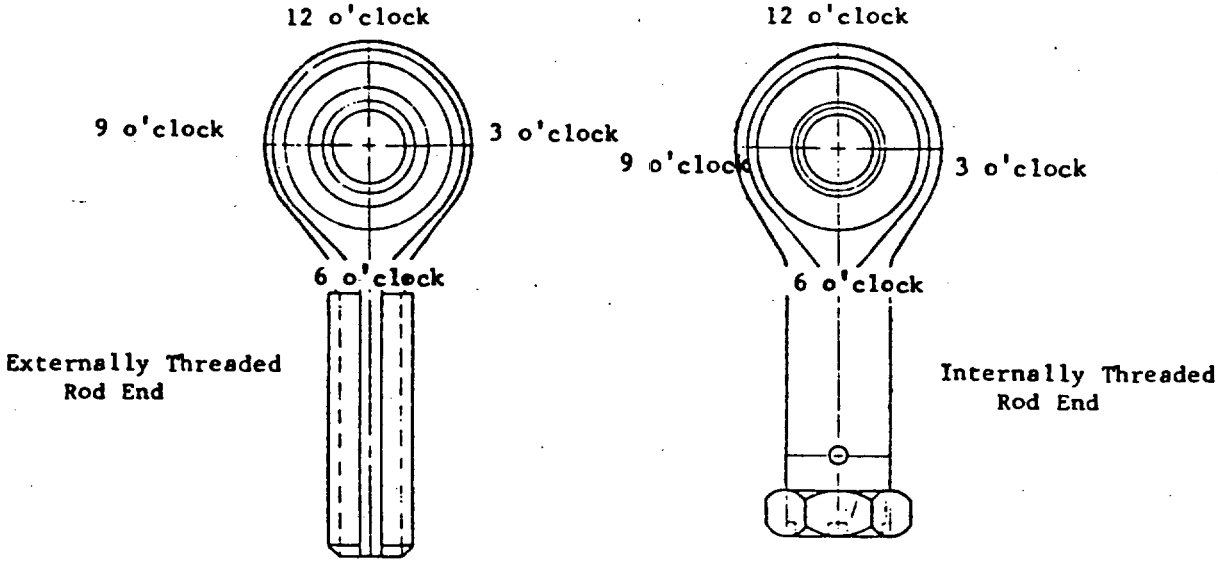
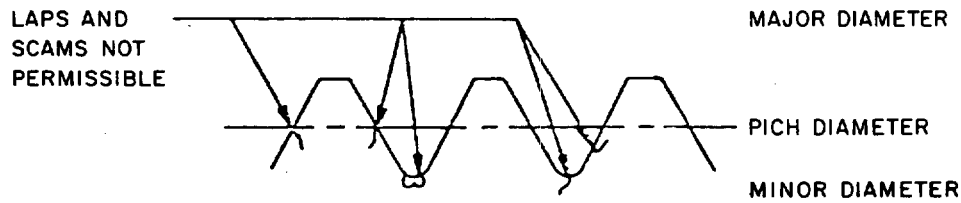
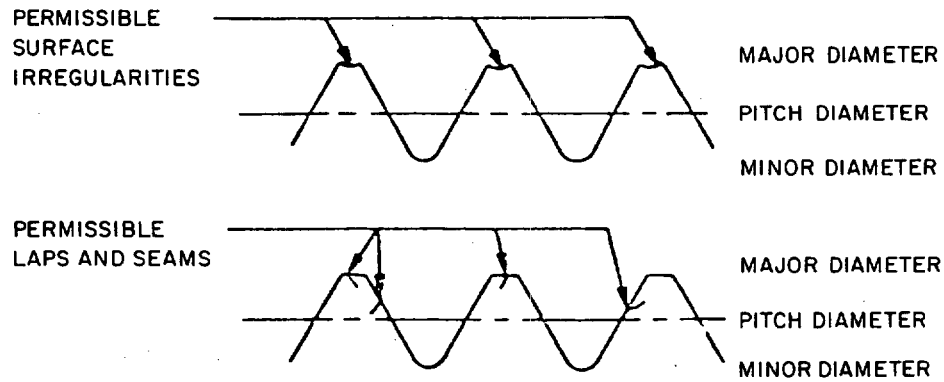


FIGURE 1. Hoop position designations.



Note: For limits see 3.5.5.2 and 3.5.5.3.

FIGURE 2. Nonpermissible laps, seams and surface irregularities.



Note: For limits see 3.5.5.5.

FIGURE 3. Permissible laps, seams and surface irregularities.

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3.9 Workmanship. The bearing shall be free of tool marks, chatter waves, rust, grinding scratches, pits, cracks or any other defects that may adversely affect their serviceability.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Responsibility for compliance. All items must meet all requirements of Sections 3 and 5. The inspection set forth in this specification shall become a part of the contractor's overall inspection system or quality program. The absence of any inspection requirements in the specification shall not relieve the contractor of the responsibility of assuring that all products or supplies submitted to the Government for acceptance comply with all requirements of the contract. Sampling in quality conformance does not authorize submission of known defective material, either indicated or actual, nor does it commit the Government to acceptance of defective material.

4.2 Qualification test records. The manufacturer shall maintain a record showing quantitative results for all tests required by this specification. This record shall be available to the purchaser and shall be signed by an authorized representative of the manufacturer or the testing laboratory, as applicable.

4.3 Classification of inspection. The examination and testing of the bearings shall be classified as:

a. Qualification inspection (4.4).

b. Quality conformance inspection (4.5).

4.4 Qualification inspections.

4.4.1 Sampling instructions. Qualification inspection samples shall consist of ten bearings of sizes -6, -8, -12 for each class (1 and 2) for which qualification is desired. The test bearings shall be furnished by the manufacturer. The bearings shall be identified and forwarded to the Naval Air Development Center, Code 6061, Warminster, PA 18974-5000.

Approval of the bearing sizes in column I will extend to approval of the corresponding sizes in column II.

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TABLE II. Order of qualifying bearings.

I	II
M81935/1-6 -8 -12	-3, -4, -5, -6 -7, -8, -10 -12, -14, -16
M81935/2-6 -8 -12	-3, -4, -5, -6 -7, -8, -10 -12, -14, -16

4.4.2 Certified test report. The manufacturer shall furnish a certified test report showing the manufacturer's product satisfactorily conforms to this specification. The test report shall include, as a minimum, actual results of the tests specified herein. When the report is submitted, it shall be accompanied by a dated drawing which completely describes the manufacturer's product by specifying all dimensions and tolerances, the part number of the bearing cartridge, anti-fretting material if used, coating or plating, and heat treatment. The manufacturer's part number for each size shall be included on the drawing.

4.4.3 Inspections. Qualification inspections shall include all the examinations and tests of this specification. The minimum number of samples per test shall be in accordance with Table III.

TABLE III. Qualification inspection samples.

Examination and Test	Paragraph No.	Samples To Be Tested
Examination of product	4.6.1	5
Preparation for delivery	4.6.2	5
Ultimate static load	4.7.1	3
Axial static proof load	4.7.2	1/ 3
Fatigue load	4.7.3	3

1/ Satisfactory test results for Class 1 bearings will apply toward qualification of Class 1 and Class 2.

4.4.4 Retention of qualification. The retention of qualification shall consist of periodic verification and shall be by certification unless otherwise specified by the activity responsible for the Qualified Products List and shall be at intervals of not more than two years.

4.5 Quality conformance inspections.

4.5.1 Bearing cartridge inspection. The bearing cartridge installed in the rod end body shall meet the requirements of paragraph 3.3. The bearing supplier shall maintain and supply to the purchaser upon demand:

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a. Certified copies of all records of quality conformance tests specified in 4.4 of MIL-B-81820.

b. Certification that the materials and manufacturing procedures used in producing the bearing cartridge are the same as those of the bearings originally qualified.

4.5.2 Rod end bearing inspection. The quality conformance inspections of the bearings shall consist of the following examinations and tests to determine conformance of the bearings to the requirements of this specification and the applicable military specification sheet. The bearing supplier shall supply written certification the bearings conform to these requirements with each inspection lot.

a.	Dimensions	3.5.1	4.6.1
b.	Identification of product	3.8	4.6.1
c.	Workmanship	3.9	4.6.1
d.	Preparation for delivery		4.6.2
e.	No-load rotational breakaway torque	3.6.5	4.7.4
f.	Hardness	3.5.3	4.7.5
g.	Magnetic particle inspection	3.5.5	4.7.6

4.5.3 Inspections. The bearing manufacturer shall be responsible for accomplishing the quality conformance inspections specified herein.

4.5.4 Lot. The lot definition, formation and size shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105.

4.5.5 Sampling. The sample bearing shall be selected in accordance with MIL-STD-105, inspection level II, acceptable quality level of 1.0 percent, except that inspection for no-load rotational breakaway torque, hardness and magnetic inspection of the rod end body shall be 100 percent.

4.6 Examinations.

4.6.1 Examination of product. The bearings shall be examined to determine conformance to the requirements of this specification and the applicable standard for material, plating, dimensions, finish, identification of product, workmanship and requirements not covered by tests.

4.6.2 Inspection of preparation for delivery. Preservation, packaging, packing and marking shall be inspected to determine conformance of Section 5.

4.7 Test methods. Unless otherwise specified, all tests shall be conducted at room temperature.

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4.7.1 Ultimate static load. The bearing shall be installed in a test fixture as shown on Figure 4, using a 0.0000 to 0.0015-inch loose fit for the shaft. The appropriate ultimate static load specified on the rod end military specification sheet shall be applied at the rate of one percent per second.

4.7.2 Axial static proof load. The bearing shall be mounted on a rigid fixture as shown on Figure 5, so that only the rod end body is supported. The axial static proof load shall be applied at the rate of one percent per second to the ball and maintained by the bearing for 30 seconds.

4.7.3 Fatigue load. The bearing shall be installed in a fatigue machine using a test fixture as shown on Figure 4, with a 0.0000 to 0.0015-inch loose fit for the shaft. The loading shall be tension-tension with the maximum load equal to the fatigue load on the applicable military specification sheet and the minimum load equal to 10 percent of the fatigue loads. Loads shall be maintained within ±2 percent. Testing speeds shall not exceed 2800 cycles per minute.

4.7.4 No-load rotational breakaway torque. The no-load rotational breakaway torque shall be determined by securing the rod end body in a fixed position while rotating the ball about the bearing axis. Torque shall be applied gradually to the ball; the minimum torque required to start the ball moving shall be recorded. The no-load rotational breakaway torque shall be as specified on the applicable standard. The ball shall be hand rotated through several revolutions immediately prior to testing.

4.7.5 Hardness. The bearings shall be tested for hardness using a standard Rockwell hardness tester. Readings for the rod end body shall be taken on the flat at the hoop-to-shank junction.

4.7.6 Discontinuities. The presence of discontinuities in rod end bodies such as cracks, laps, seams and inclusions shall be determined by magnetic particle inspection. Magnetic particle indications of themselves shall not be cause for rejection. If, in the opinion of the Inspector, the indications are cause for rejection, representative samples shall be taken from those bearings showing indications which shall be further examined by microexamination to determine whether the indicated discontinuities are in accordance with the limits specified herein.

4.7.6.1 Magnetic particle inspection. Alloy steel rod end bodies shall be inspected in accordance with MIL-STD-1949. The inspection shall be by both the longitudinal and circular methods.

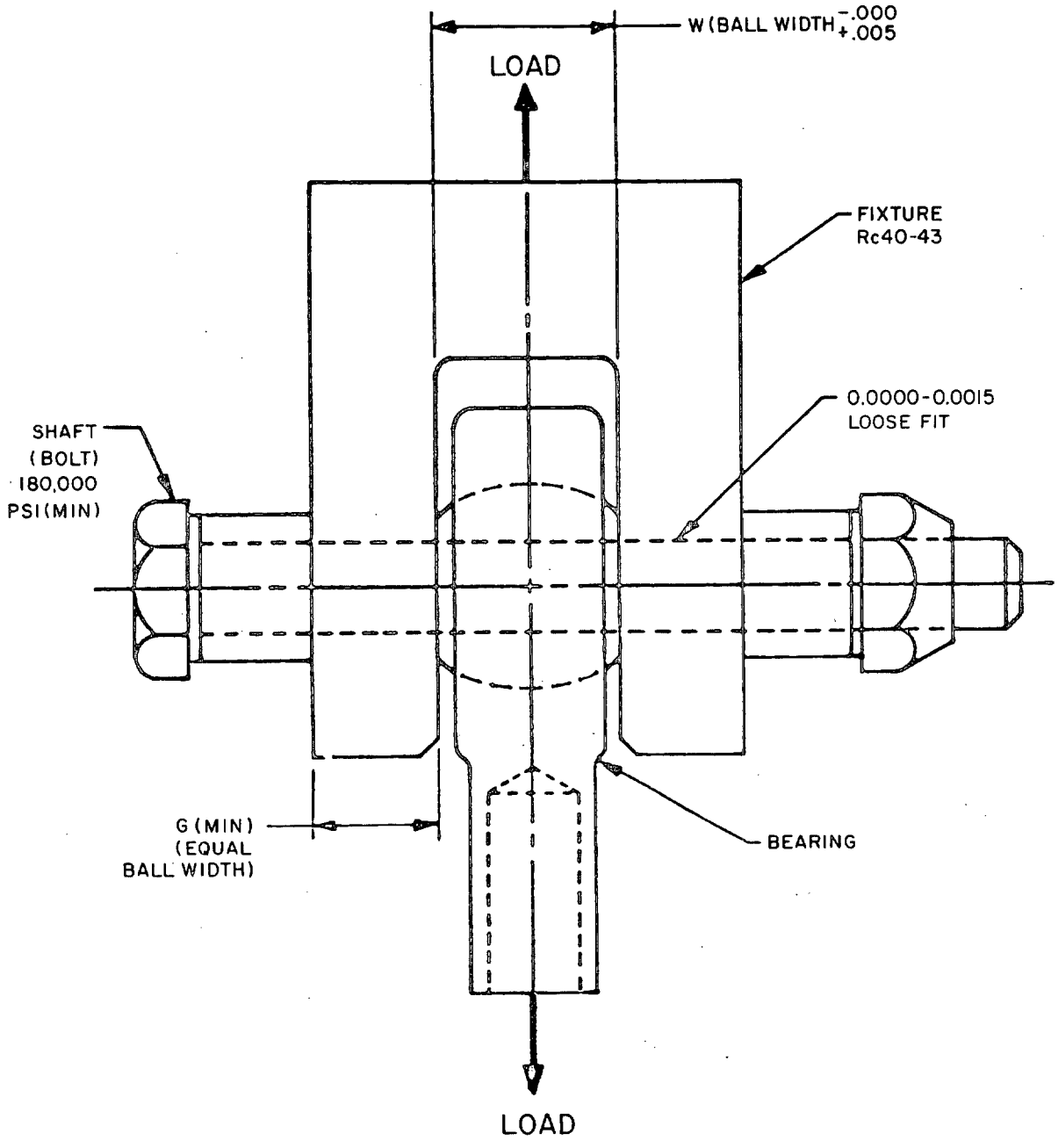
5. PACKAGING

5.1 Preservation. Packaging shall be in accordance with Level A or Level C as specified in paragraph 6.2. These bearings will not tolerate cleaning solvent, grease or oil. Prior to packaging, bearings shall be cleaned in one of the following ways:

a. Clean with dry compressed air per MIL-P-116.

b. Wiping with soft, clean cloth per MIL-P-116.

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DIMENSIONS IN INCHES

FIGURE 4. Ultimate and fatigue test fixture.

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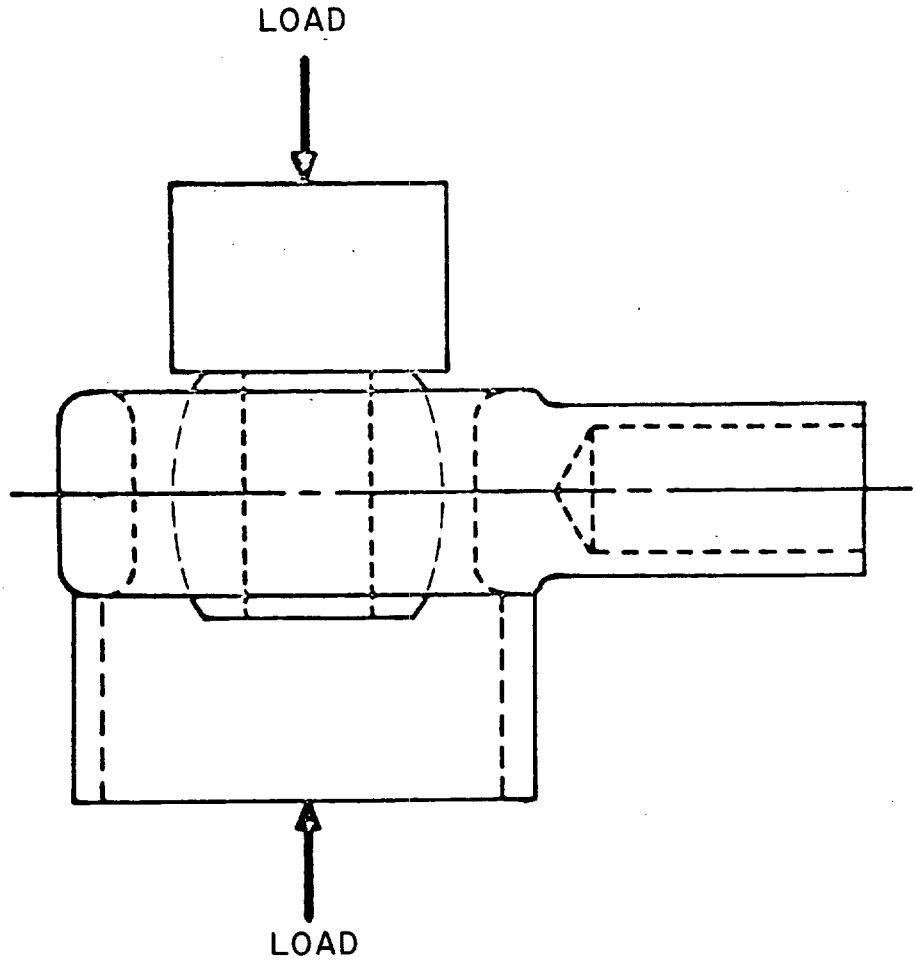


FIGURE 5. Axial load test setup.

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c. Manufacturer's established cleaning procedures for this bearing.

5.1.1 Level A. Packaging shall be in accordance with Level A of MIL-B-197. The manufacturer's lot control numbers shall be marked on each package.

5.1.2 Level C. Packaging shall be in accordance with the fabricators commercial practice. The manufacturer's lot control number shall be marked on each package.

5.2 Packing.

5.2.1 Level A. Bearings packaged as specified in 5.1.1 shall be packed for overseas shipment and storage in accordance with MIL-B-197.

5.2.2 Level B. Bearings packaged as specified in 5.1.1 shall be packed for domestic shipment and storage in accordance with MIL-B-197.

5.2.3 Level C. Bearings packaged as specified in 5.1.2 shall be packed in a manner to insure carrier acceptance and safe delivery at destination. The containers shall be in accordance with the Uniform Freight Classification Rules or regulations of other carriers, as applicable to the mode of transportation.

5.3 Marking. Interior packages and exterior shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129. The nomenclature shall include: BEARINGS, PLAIN, ROD END, SELF-ALIGNING, SELF-LUBRICATING.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. These bearings are intended primarily for use in airframe applications of high loads at low rotational oscillatory speeds. For specific design information on the capability of these bearings under particular load, speed and wear/life conditions, the user is referred to MIL-STD-1599.

6.2 Ordering data.

6.2.1 Acquisition requirements. Acquisition documents should specify the following:

a. Title, number and date of this specification.

b. Military identifying part number (see 3.8).

c. Applicable levels of preservation, packaging and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).

d. Quality assurance certification.

6.3 Qualification. With respect to products requiring qualification, awards will be made only for products which are, at the time set for opening of bids, qualified for inclusion in Qualified Products List 81935 whether or

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not such products have actually been so listed by that date. The attention of the contractors is called to these requirements and manufacturers are urged to arrange to have the products that they propose to offer to the Federal Government tested for qualification in order that they may be eligible to be awarded contracts or purchase orders for the products covered by this specification. The activity responsible for the Qualified Products List is the Naval Air Engineering Center, Systems Engineering and Standardization Department, Code 5311, Lakehurst, NJ 08733-5100 and information pertaining to qualification of products may be obtained from that activity; however, information pertaining to qualification of products may be obtained from the Naval Air Development Center, Code 6061, Warminster, PA 18974-5000.

6.3.1 Authorization for submittal of samples. A manufacturer seeking qualification approval of his product will be authorized to submit samples for such approval only upon presentation of certified test reports and drawings indicating that his product conforms to this specification.

6.4 Subject term (keyword) listing.

Bearing
Rod-end

6.5 Changes from previous issue. The margins of this specification are marked with vertical lines to indicate where changes from the previous issue were made. This was done as a convenience only and the Government assumes no liability whatsoever for any inaccuracies in these notations. Bidders and contractors are cautioned to evaluate the requirements of this document based on the entire content irrespective of the marginal notations and relationship to the last previous issue.

Custodians:
Navy - AS
Air Force - 11
Army - AV

Reviewer activities:
Navy - SH
Air Force - 99
Army - AR
DLA - IS

User activity:
Navy - SH

Preparing activity:
Navy - AS
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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT TITLE
MIL-B-81935A	Bearings, Plain, Rod End Self-Aligning, Self-Lubricating, General Specification for

3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4. TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*
	☐ VENDOR ☐ USER ☐ MANUFACTURER ☐ OTHER *(Specify)*: _____
b. ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)*	

5. PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording:

b. Recommended Wording:

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation:

6. REMARKS

7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional	b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional
c. MAILING ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* – Optional	8. DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

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